Feedback for academic communication

Does feedback help students develop communication?

LANGUAGE / ASSESSMENT

ONE-PAGE TEACHING GUIDE

WHAT IS IT?

Feedback addresses communication development, not just correctness

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

University contains many hidden rules: what "critical analysis" means, what a rubric is really asking for, when it is acceptable to ask for help, or what counts as "professional" behaviour. If those rules remain unspoken, familiarity can be mistaken for capability.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- "Everyone else seems to know rules nobody has explained."
- "I understand the topic, but not what I am being asked to do."

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Comment on how effectively meaning is being made, not only surface errors.
- Prioritise the next most useful improvement rather than listing every issue.
- Where possible, create a later opportunity to apply the feedback.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

Feedback on a draft highlights one language or structure issue that would most improve the student's ability to communicate their ideas clearly.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

For this assessment, we aim to use feedback to help students develop disciplinary and academic communication, not only correct errors. The learning outcomes being assessed are [insert outcomes].

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View the Influential Communicators example

Creating and using rubrics

Feedback for learning